

Jobs To Be Done

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What the customer hires the product to do

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Jobs To Be Done (JTBD) is a theory holding that customers 'hire' products and services to make progress on a specific job in a particular circumstance, so innovation should target the job rather than the demographic.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Developed by Clayton Christensen and colleagues (notably Bob Moesta and Tony Ulwick's related outcome-driven variant), articulated in *Competing Against Luck* (2016).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Christensen argued that correlation-based segmentation misled innovators; framing demand as a job clarifies why customers switch and what would make them switch to you.

FIGURE 1 · JOBS TO BE DONE



Figure 1. A schematic of the Jobs To Be Done as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

The team identifies the functional, emotional and social job, the circumstances that trigger it, and the obstacles the current solution leaves unresolved.

WHEN IT IS USED

During product strategy, opportunity sensing and when AI features risk being built for activity rather than genuine customer progress.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product, innovation and marketing leaders.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It replaces demographic and feature-led thinking with a causal account of demand, sharpening where AI should add value.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Customer Journey Map · Slibrary 2

Moments of Truth · Slibrary 2

Engagement Flywheel · Slibrary 2

Personalisation Ladder · Slibrary 2

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Christensen, C.M. et al. (2016) *Competing Against Luck*. New York: HarperBusiness.

Ulwick, A. (2005) *What Customers Want*. New York: McGraw-Hill.